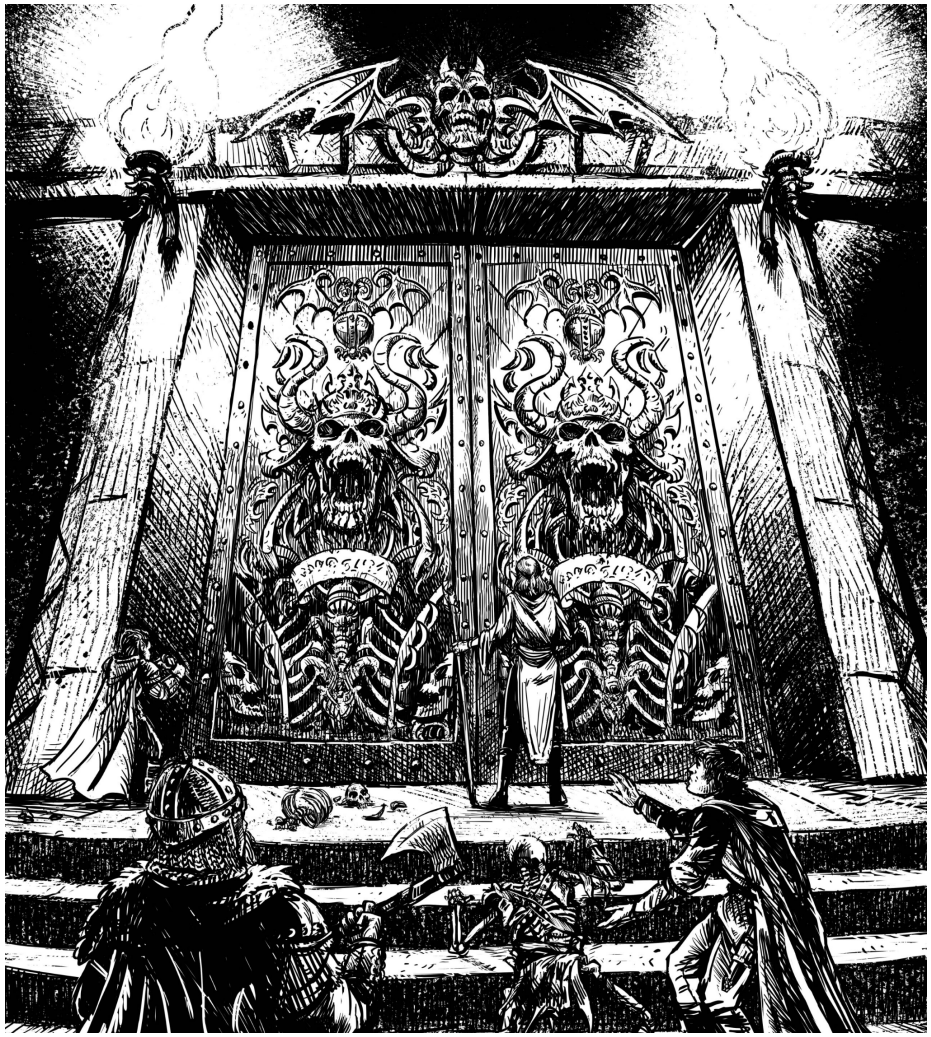


Character Creation

Player Handbook

Your trusty player handbook for fantasy gaming.



Ancestries, equipment, star signs, and more!

Character Creation

Use the following steps to create a character.

The Six Abilities

Strength measures physical might and power.

Dexterity measures agility, coordination, reflexes, and balance.

Constitution gauges health and durability.

Intelligence reflects logical reasoning, memory, and knowledge.

Wisdom measures intuition, insight, and willpower.

Charisma reflects personal magnetism and charm.

Determine Abilities

Roll six d6s and allocate each die to a different ability, choosing how to allocate them or doing it at random. Use the table below to determine their abilities. Then allocate 2 points to your abilities, with each point granting +1. You can allocate both points to the same ability for a +2 bonus.

d6	Ability Score
1	-1
2	+0
3-4	+1
5-6	+2

If you did not roll at least one 5 on your six d6 rolls, you may re-roll.

Class

Choose one of the available Classes that fits with your character's abilities.

Ancestry

You can pick one of the ancestries listed below. Your size is Medium and your creature type is humanoid. You know the Common language and one language or dialect that makes sense in the world as determined by both you and the DM.

Catfolk

Nocturnal. You have Darkvision with a range of 60 feet.

Claws. You can use your claws as natural weapons for your Unarmed Strikes. They have the finesse property and you count as being proficient with them when attacking. They deal 1d6 slashing damage on a hit.

Elf

Elven Background. Pick one of the following options.

- **Fleet of Foot.** You gain proficiency with Dexterity saves and one related skill. If your class grants you proficiency with such saves or skills, you instead gain expertise with them.
- **Resilient Body.** You gain proficiency with Constitution saves and one related skill. If your class grants you proficiency with such saves, you instead gain expertise with them.
- **Wizened Mind.** You gain proficiency with Wisdom saves and one related skill. If your class grants you proficiency with such saves, you instead gain expertise with them.

Arcane Soul. You know one cantrip of your choice from any spell list. Choose any stat as your casting stat for it.

Human

Jack of all Trades. Increase your proficiency bonus by +1.

Lizardfolk

Scales. Your scales give you +1 AC.

Amphibious. You can breathe both water and air.

Reptilian. You gain resistance to poison damage.

Orc

Orcish Determination. On your turn, you can enter a focused, determined state. For the next 10 minutes you gain advantage on all attacks, checks, and saving throws. You also gain a bonus to damage rolls equal to half your level (minimum +1). Once you use this feature, you cannot use it again until you finish a long rest.

Indomitable. On your turn, you can tap into a well of energy and toughness. You regain 1d8 + your Constitution modifier hit points. This amount increases by 1d8 when you reach level 5 (2d8) and 9 (3d8). Once you use this feature, you cannot use it again until you finish a long rest.

Background

You have decided to embark on a life of adventure. Why grind away at a mundane career when you can risk life and limb in search of treasures hidden in monster infested holes in the ground? You background determines your skills and languages.

Skills

You select one of the skill packages listed below.

- **Merchant**: Deception, Insight, Performance, Persuasion
- **Scholar**: Arcana, History, Medicine, Religion
- **Soldier**: Athletics, Intimidation, Medicine, Perception
- **Thief**: Athletics, Investigation, Sleight of Hand, Stealth
- **Wanderer**: Animal Handling, Nature, Perception, Survival

With your DM's permission, you can create your own skill package by picking four skills.

Expertise and Ancestry. If your background gives you a skill granted by your ancestry, you gain expertise with that skill.

Languages

You know Common. The DM may provide you a list of languages in their world that scholar's might reasonably study. If they do, you may choose a number of those languages to learn equal to to your Intelligence modifier (minimum 0).

Known Languages. Common, High Elvish, Dark Elvish, Wood Elvish, Orcish, Saxhleel, Taagra, and Daedric.

Star Sign

Choose your Star Sign, what constellation were you born under?

Equipment

You start with a belt pouch, and a pack of choice. Each starter pack contains basic adventurer equipment like torches and rations along with a few special items tailored to their specific context. Your class grants you starting weapons and armor.

Starter Packs

Pack	Bonus Items
Merchant's Pack	Scale, Lockbox, Fine Clothes, Mirror
Scholar's Pack	Book, Ink pen, 10 pieces of parchment and envelopes, Signet ring, Wax
Soldier's Pack	Crowbar, Rope (50'), 8 oil flasks
Thieves' Pack	Crowbar, Thieves' Tools, Bag of ball bearings, 10 caltrops
Wanderer's Pack	Tent, Hunting trap, Rope (50')

Equipment

This section provides the rules for equipment that characters can buy.

Weight

Generally speaking, your total carry weight is not expected to be tracked exactly at the pound granularity. Instead, the number of pounds a character can carry is intended to serve as a reference point for how much stuff they can have on them given their size, strength, and equipment. The DM ultimately determines what can and can't be carried based on the situation.

Coins

The table below summarizes the values of the standard coins. 100 coins weighs roughly 2 pounds and fit neatly into a small purse or bag.

Coin	Gold Piece
Copper Piece (CP)	1/100
Silver Piece (SP)	1/10
Gold Piece (GP)	1
Platinum Piece (PP)	10

The silver coin is the benchmark for the economy. One silver piece is the rough equivalent of one day of standard "peasant" labor assuming a fantasy world with lots of economic and power inequality. The most expensive items will often be quite expensive compared to this figure.

Inventory

Your inventory determines how many items you can carry and how easy they are to access during an encounter.

Items

Inventory is measured in pounds. You can carry a maximum number of pounds equal to 50 plus 20 multiplied by your Strength modifier, stated mathematically as (50 + (20 * Strength)).

Equipped. You can have up to two items readied in your hands, or one item that requires two hands to hold. You can have up to three weapons at hand that you can switch between once on your turn as a free action.

Encumbrance

If you try carrying too much weight, it slows you down.

Encumbered. If you are carrying above your weight limit, you are encumbered. While encumbered, on your turn you can either move or use an action, not both. You have disadvantage on all rolls, and attacks against you have advantage. If you try carrying more than double your limit, you cannot move or use actions in addition to the other penalties listed above.

Weapons

The weapons table after this section summarizes the armaments you can purchase. The table features several headers, starting with the weapon's name.

Category. Every weapon falls into a category: Blade, Blunt, Bow, Mechanical, Polearm, and Shield.

Damage. The table lists the amount of damage a weapon deals as well as the type of that damage. Weapons deal either bludgeoning, slashing, or piercing damage based on their category. Blades can do slashing or piercing damage, blunt does bludgeoning damage, etc.

Hands. Each weapon lists if you can wield it in one or two hands.

Properties. Any properties a weapon has are listed in the Properties column.

Price. The item's cost.

Weapon	Category	Damage	Hands	Properties	Price
Club	Blunt	1d4	One	Light, Melee	1sp
Mace	Blunt	1d6	One	Melee	5gp
Warhammer	Blunt	1d8	One	Melee	10gp
Maul	Blunt	1d12	Two	Melee	15gp
Staff	Polearm	1d6	One	Melee	2 sp
Spear	Polearm	1d6	One	Melee, Thrown	5 gp
Halberd	Polearm	1d10	Two	Melee, Reach	10 gp
Dagger	Blade	1d4	One	Finesse, Light, Melee, Thrown	3 gp
Handaxe	Blade	1d6	One	Light, Melee, Thrown	2 gp
Battleaxe	Blade	1d8	One	Melee	10 gp
Sabre	Blade	1d6	One	Finesse, Light, Melee	10 gp
Longsword	Blade	1d8	One	Melee	15 gp
Rapier	Blade	1d8	One	Finesse, Melee	15 gp
Greataxe	Blade	1d12	Two	Melee	20 gp
Greatsword	Blade	2d6	Two	Melee	30 gp
Sling	Bow	1d4	One	Ammo (bullets), Ranged	1 sp
Shortbow	Bow	1d6	Two	Ammo (arrows), Ranged	2 gp
Longbow	Bow	1d8	Two	Ammo (arrows), Ranged	3 gp
Light Crossbow	Mechanical	1d6	One	Ammo (bolts), Ranged	15 gp
Heavy Crossbow	Mechanical	1d8	Two	Ammo (bolts), Ranged	25 gp
Small Shield	Shield	——	One	Melee	5gp
Large Shield	Shield	1d4	One	Melee	10gp

Weapon Properties

This section details the different weapon properties.

Ammo. This ranged weapon consumes the listed ammo each time you use it to attack. You draw and ready the ammo as part of attacking with it. If you don't have that ammo, you can't attack with that weapon. The prices for these weapons includes 20 pieces of ammo.

Finesse. When you make an attack with this weapon, you can use your Dexterity modifier in place of Strength for attack and damage rolls.

Light. Some features and abilities specify the use of a light weapon, mainly two-weapon fighting.

Melee. This weapon can be used to make melee attacks.

Ranged. This weapon can be used to make ranged attacks against targets within 300 feet. You use your Dexterity modifier for ranged attack and damage rolls.

Reach. This long weapon adds 5 feet to your reach.

Thrown. This weapon can be used to make ranged attacks against targets within 30 feet.

Armor and Shields

The armor listings after this section summarize the protection you can purchase. The description features several components, starting with the armor's name. All armor has a combination of benefits and drawbacks depending on its design.

Strength. How much Strength you must have to wear the armor without becoming tired after 10 minutes of activity in the armor, granting the dazed condition until the armor is taken off and a short rest is taken.

Weight. How much the armor weighs in pounds and thus how tiring it is to wear.

AC. When you wear the armor, use the listed calculation to determine your AC

AC Bonus. Shields give a bonus to AC while you wield them. Helmets give a bonus to AC while you wear them. You can gain the AC bonus from one shield and one helmet at a time.

Disadvantage. While wearing the armor, you have disadvantage on the listed checks and saves.

Price. The item's cost.

Armor	Strengt	Weigh	AC	Disadvantage	Price
Padded Jacket	——	5	8 + Dex	Swim	10 gp
Breastplate	0	10	9 + Dex	Swim	50 gp
Scale Mail	1	20	11 + Dex (Max 2)	Swim, Acrobatics, Dexterity Saves	30 gp
Chain Mail	2	40	12 + Dex (Max 1)	Swim, Acrobatics, StealthDexterity Saves	50 gp
Half Plate	3	60	14	Swim, Acrobatics, Stealth, Dexterity Saves	500 gp
Plate Armor	4	80	15	Swim, Acrobatics, Stealth, Dexterity Saves, Bows	1,500 gp

In addition to the suit of armor you wear, you can separately choose whether to don a helmet or wield a shield. Shields require you have their weapon proficiency to gain the bonus to AC.

Helment	Weight	AC Bonus	Disadvantage	Price
Open Helm	2	+1	Perception	10 gp
Great Helm	5	+2	Perception, Ranged attacks	100 gp

Shield	Strength	Weight	AC Bonus	Price
Shield, Small	1	5	+1	5 gp
Shield, Large	2	10	+2	10 gp

Star Signs

Mortals born under a certain sign are thought to have certain characteristics granted by the celestial realms. The year has twelve months, each watched over by a sign. The thirteenth sign, the Serpent, has no month and wanders, thought by many to represent a cursed birth.

The Ritual

The first month, known as Morning Star and the bringer of the new year.

Blessed Touch. You have an innate connection to the mystical powers of the celestial realm and can calm someone's nerves with a simple touch and kind word. You are responsible and motivated by duty to your word and oaths.

The Lover

The second month, known as Sun's Dawn and the herald of a hopeful spring to come.

Mooncalf. You are a hopeless romantic and live for the drama. You care deeply for those close to you and love heavily, even when it gets you in trouble. You are never slow to defend what you love, and will fight if that's what it takes to safeguard it.

The Lord

The third month, known as First Seed and the bringer of the spring equinox.

Kings Blood. You are arrogant and haughty, but also highly capable and often correct, however frustrating that is for those around you. You have lofty ambitions and philosophize about the nature of mortals often. Ultimately, you seek to improve the lives of those around you, but it doesn't always come across that way. Sometimes its because you are lost. Usually its because others are too blind to see the obviously correct path you laid out.

The Mage

The fourth month, known as Rain's Hand and the bringer of life to nature.

Fay. You are focused on the nature of reality and seek to understand great mysteries. The world is a puzzle to you, and like any puzzle it can be solved, and you will solve it. You get bored easily, and are always looking for your next challenge.

The Shadow

The fifth month, known as Second Seed and the beginning of summer.

Moonshadow. You are quiet and reserved, yet observant. You often go unnoticed, but rarely fail to notice something out of the ordinary. You are ever shifting and elusive to others.

The Steed

The sixth month, known as Midyear and the bringer of the summer solstice.

Charioteer. You are bold and charismatic, and have the energy to go great distances to get what you want. You never stop until you have what you want.

The Apprentice

The seventh month, known as Sun's Height and the peak of summer and festivals.

Elfborn. You are always curious and humble about your knowledge, never

feeling content with what you know, ever yearning for more. You often take on new problems and the problems of others even before figuring out your own.

The Warrior

The eighth month, known as Last Seed and the end of summer.

Warwyrd. You are a protector and guardian. You have ambitions to stand out from the crowd, but also have warmth to care for those you love.

The Lady

The ninth month, known as Hearthfire and the bringer of the autumnal equinox.

Lady's Favor. You have elegant and almost regal presence about you. You always try to have a solution for every problem, and attempt to right any ship that seems to veer off course. You judge harshly, but with care and intent to improve it. Something that isn't working is harm waiting to happen.

The Tower

The tenth month, known as Frostfall and the end of autumn and harvest festivals.

Tower Key. You are solitary by nature. You often avoid conflict, retreating into yourself or your hobbies and fantasies to avoid confrontation. You are stubborn, but underneath it all you have a strong moral compass and eye for the truth. You see all the sides of a disagreement and, given time, can find the path towards consensus.

The Atronach

The eleventh month, known as Sun's Dusk and the beginning of winter.

Wombburn. You are guarded and reserved. You put up walls for protection and it works. You absorb the energy of those around you. But, you can lower your walls when you feel safe. Inside, there is a great warmth, power, and ability to connect with others, should you choose to embrace it.

The Thief

The twelfth month, known as Evening Star and the bringer of the winter solstice.

Hara. You are cunning and clever, and always looking for the next thing to add to your collection. You have an eye for beauty and aren't afraid to be the best. You are outgoing and friendly, but also a little untrustworthy.

The Serpent

The Serpent has no month. It wanders through the sky at will, unbound to the calendar, and its appearance is said to herald upheaval.

Star-Cursed. You are severed spiritually from others, but yearn to be connected. You are comfortable in silence and emptiness. You feel a latent power rests deep within you, destined to be awoken one day. Until then, you can't help but envy the connection shared by those around you. One day, you can't help but feel that everything will change.

Talents

Talents are special features that you can use to customize your character.

Optional Rule. Talents are an optional rule. You can ignore them in a game where you prefer streamlined, simpler characters. The DM might also customize the list of available talents to reflect the campaign setting and tone.

Gaining Talents. You can gain a talent whenever there is an extended period of downtime in a campaign after finishing an arc. You can gain at most 1 talent prior to level 5 and 2 talents prior to level 9. Once you reach level 10, gaining talents becomes the dominant form of character progression since 10 is the max level.

Prerequisites. Some talents require proficiency in a skill, weapon, or other specific attributes of your character. Some talents also have a minimum level.

Alchemist Novice

Prerequisite: Intelligence +2 or higher

You learn how to craft common potions and weapons from exotic materials. Crafting items requires a period of downtime and raw materials as determined by the DM. At minimum, the raw materials can be purchased at any market that sells the appropriate supply gear and costs half the price of what the crafted item would normally cost to buy.

Alchemist Adept

Prerequisite: Intelligence +3 or higher, Alchemist Novice

You learn how to craft uncommon potions and armor from exotic materials. Crafting items requires a period of downtime and raw materials as determined by the DM. At minimum, the raw materials can be purchased at any market that sells the appropriate supply gear and costs half the price of what the crafted item would normally cost to buy.

Alchemist Master

Prerequisite: Intelligence +5 or higher, Alchemist Adept

You learn how to craft rare magic items of any type, provided you have the formulae for them. Crafting items requires a period of downtime and raw materials as determined by the DM. At minimum, the raw materials can be purchased at any market that sells the appropriate supply gear and costs half the price of what the crafted item would normally cost to buy. Some rare magic items require special ingredients from monsters or other sources that cannot be bought easily.

Arcane Training

Prerequisite: Intelligence +1 or higher

You learn a wizard or illusionist cantrip of your choice.

Customizer

Prerequisite: Level 10

Work with the DM to create an ability unique to your character!

Druidic Training

Prerequisite: Wisdom +1 or higher

You learn druidic magic allowing you to speak with animals. You must perform a ritual that takes 1 minute in order to activate this ability which then lasts for 1 hour.

Linguist

Prerequisite: Intelligence +1 or higher

You pick up basic training in many different languages, both current and ancient. Whenever you read or hear a language, you can make a DC 10 Intelligence check. On a success, you understand at least half of the words and meaning of the text or spoken words. If the result was a 20 or higher, you understand at least 90 percent.

Merchant Apprentice

Prerequisite: Charisma +2 or higher

You have developed the connections and experience to have readily available contacts that carry exquisite items most folk would have a hard time tracking down. This may come in the form of attracting an alchemist to your local town, or knowing the right trading caravan routes and associates. However your character as acquired these contacts, you have access to buying fine weapons and armor from exotic materials. You also have access to buying or selling common an uncommon magic items and potions at a fair price, along with many ingredients needed for crafting.

Merchant Journeyman

Prerequisite: Charisma +3 or higher, Merchant Apprentice

Your connections grow in their talent and breadth. You now have access to rare items and ingredients.

Merchant Master

Prerequisite: Charisma +5 or higher, Merchant Journeyman

Your connections grow in their talent and breadth to master levels. You now have access to very rare items and ingredients. Note, some magic items are legendary or unique, and cannot be bought or sold, even with access to the best alchemists and enchanters in the realm.

Mystic Training

Prerequisite: Wisdom +1 or higher

You learn a mystic cantrip of your choice.

Skill Training

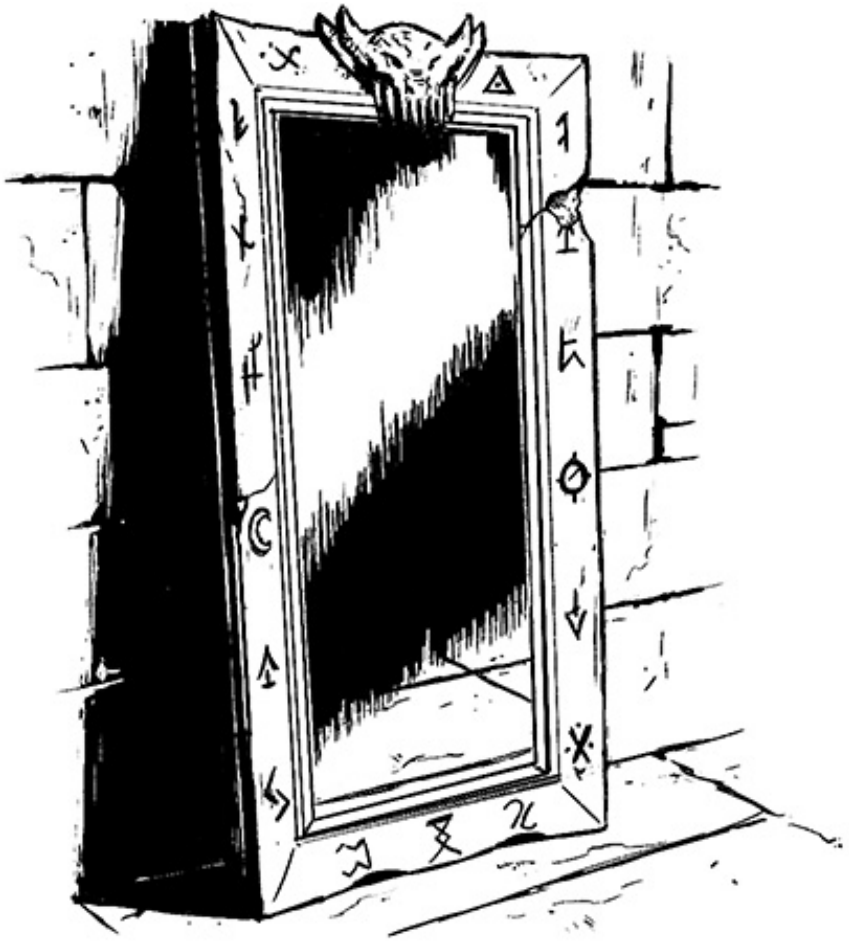
Prerequisite: Intelligence +1 or higher

You gain proficiency with a skill, or expertise in a skill that you are already proficient with.

Weapon Training

Prerequisite: Strength or Dexterity +1 or higher

You gain proficiency with a weapon category of your choice.



Who are you?